

CONFLICT OVERVIEW

Here is a high-level summary of how to make an attack...

1. Choose an **asset** to use in the attack.
2. Based on the type of attack you are making, choose an appropriate **skill** and **drive**, as well as a **focus** if one applies.
3. Roll your contest against the target.
 - a. If you **win** the contest, your attack is successful.
 - b. If you **lose** the contest, your attack fails.
4. On a successful attack, the outcome depends on your target.
 - a. If your foe is a **minor** character, they are defeated.
 - b. Otherwise, defeating the foe is an **extended task** with a requirement equal to the foe's most appropriate skill. Each successful attack scores points equal to 2 plus the Quality of their asset. Once the task's requirement has been reached, the foe is defeated.

Nasir also has a personal shield, but the gamemaster tells him that won't be any use if his ornithopter is forced out of the sky. He might also create the trait 'Clear Skies' for the environment, but as that helps the enemy pilot as well the advantages cancel each other out.

Having declared all the traits they wish to use, Nasir and the enemy pilot make an opposed test against each other. Nasir gains a success and so defeats his opponent. In this case he describes forcing the other ornithopter out of the sky with some clever flying.

ATTACKS, DEFEAT, AND RECOVERY

A common choice in conflicts, characters may attempt to defeat their opponents in order to remove those opponents from the conflict. Any action where the goal is to defeat an opponent is classified as an attack, and defeated opponents are no longer able to participate in that conflict: they may be injured or even dead, they may have been forced out of a social gathering, or they're otherwise incapable of continuing to affect the conflict.

Example: *Having taken out an enemy ornithopter, Nasir is feeling confident, until he notices a cannon turret activating and taking aim at him. The turret is an asset that was already in the zone Nasir has entered, so now the gamemaster decides to use it.*

The gamemaster makes an attack with the turret against Nasir in the ornithopter and wins the opposed test. This would defeat a minor character, but Nasir is far more than that! So, the test must be an extended test, which in this case has a requirement of 4. The cannon turret is a powerful asset with a Quality of 1, so the gamemaster scores a total of 3 of the 4 points they need, leaving only 1 left. Another hit, and Nasir will be blown out of the sky!

Making an attack is always a **contest**, because it affects another character. The type of contest, and the skill and assets involved, can differ depending on what kind of conflict you're engaging in (personal, espionage, etc.), as well as the circumstances of that conflict. For example, a skirmish normally involves the Battle skill and a melee weapon, while an intrigue interaction might use the Communicate skill and a blackmail asset. (Examples of appropriate contests appear in each combat type section later in this chapter.)

CONTEST RESULTS

If you **win** the contest, then you successfully attack the enemy—see **Successful Attack Outcomes**, following. If you **lose** the contest, then your attack has failed, and the action ends. You may not Keep the Initiative after failing. Regardless of the result, complications may allow the enemy to gain an advantage over you, like opening you up for a counterattack.

SUCCESSFUL ATTACK OUTCOMES

- ❖ If the attack is against a minor non-player character or minor supporting character, then a successful attack against them means they are **defeated**.
- ❖ If the attack is against a notable or major non-player character, a notable supporting character, or a main player character—or if the target is a military asset in a warfare conflict—then defeating the character is an **extended task**, with a requirement equal to the most appropriate skill of the character. Each successful attack scores points equal to 2 plus the Quality of the asset used; you may spend 2 points of Momentum to increase the Quality of the asset by +1 for that attack only. Once the task's requirement has been reached, the character is defeated.

As noted above, a defeated character can no longer take part in the scene, at least until they've had an opportunity to recover. This may require time, action from allies (see below), a specific condition being met (such as restoring a tarnished reputation after a social defeat), or some combination of the three.

Some defeats may be impossible to fully recover from, such as serious debilitating injuries or death—though permanent defeats for player characters should be rare, as anyone as significant as a player character is likely to be captured, to ransom or subvert, since they're too valuable to simply kill. Defeats with a long-lasting effect may add new traits to player characters, at the gamemaster's discretion, reflecting permanent effects from injury, disgrace, or similar. **If you want to inflict a lasting injury on an opponent, spend 2 points of Momentum after the attack which defeats that opponent.**

DEFENSIVE ASSETS

The attacker's final Difficulty increases by +1 for each defensive asset in the target's zone. Essentially, a defensive asset is a trait that can be used to increase the Difficulty of any attack to that zone. With the attacker

RESISTING DEFEAT

Some characters are harder to overcome than others, possessing a limited ability to fend off the attacks—literal or figurative—that would lay them low. This kind of desperate, last-ditch survival cannot be achieved often, and it always comes at a price: something lost, something suffered, or some advantage given to the enemy.

All player characters have this option, as do all notable and major non-player characters, and all notable supporting characters.

Once per scene, if your character would be defeated, you may choose to **Resist Defeat**. Resisting defeat prevents that defeat from occurring—your character remains active in the scene. When you choose to Resist Defeat, it costs 1 point of Momentum, or adds 1 to Threat, and causes you to suffer a complication (non-player characters opposing the players spend Threat instead). This complication could cause the loss of one of your assets, an advantage the enemy has gained over you, or some hindrance suffered avoiding the defeat.

The amount of Momentum or Threat spent to Resist Defeat increases by an amount equal to the Quality of the asset used to cause that defeat; it's harder to avoid an injury caused by a poisoned dagger than some ruffian's blade. The attacker inflicting the defeat can increase this cost further by spending Momentum.

doing the work of initiating the conflict, this is simply the best use of a defensive asset.

In many cases a defensive asset cannot move. Armor is worn on one part of the body, shields cover the whole body (for the most part). Defenses are set up and remain where they are to protect a zone. However, a few defensive assets can be moved as a more active defense. A half shield can be moved to keep the protected side towards the attacker. A knife can be used to parry and is therefore treated like a defensive asset if in the same zone as an attacking one.

The Quality rating of a defensive asset should be added to the requirement of the extended test to defeat the wielder. For this reason, attacking and removing defensive assets from an opponent can be a vital tactic.

TARGETING ASSETS

Denying assets to the enemy is a key element of conflict—the fewer assets they have, the harder it is for them to attack you or defend against your attacks—so targeting assets is likely to be a common choice of action.

First, select the asset you wish to target. Then describe how you are trying to remove that asset from play, and make a skill test. Typically speaking, targeting an asset is a skill test with a Difficulty of 2. If the asset is being wielded directly by a character—as in, it is an object in their hands—then it is a contest instead.

If the test is passed, then the outcome depends on what kind of asset has been targeted. An intangible asset is destroyed. A tangible asset is set aside, unable to be used by their owner, but continuing to exist; that asset can be recovered as an action, or at the end of the scene.

CREATING A TRAIT OR ASSET

It's likely that you'll seek to try and shift circumstances in your favor during a conflict. This may come about by establishing new facts and details about the current scene or environment, by creating a trait, or by obtaining or revealing a new tool or resource at your disposal by creating an asset.

If you wish to create a trait, describe the sort of effect you want, and how you wish to create it. Then, attempt a skill test with a Difficulty of 2. If you pass, then you've managed to create the desired trait.

Creating an asset works in the same way, but there are some limitations to the kinds of assets you can create. A created asset has a Quality of 0, and it should be useful in the current type of conflict. This can be an intangible asset, such as advantageous positioning in a skirmish or duel, additional preparations, useful information, or some other non-physical benefit. Alternatively, it could be a tangible asset, but this must be something that your character could reasonably have concealed from everyone else (and

you're revealing it now), or something which you could find in the scene.

Assets created in this way are temporary and cease to exist at the end of the scene; whatever the asset represents is discarded or ceases to be useful. You may spend 2 points of Momentum to make an asset created during a scene permanent, in which case it is added to the list of assets on your character sheet.

Example: *While Nasir is maintaining a distraction, Kara has landed and entered the facility. But upon seeing Nasir is in trouble, she decides to try and neutralize the cannon turret. As she is some distance away, she needs some sort of asset to do so. Kara's player spends Momentum and makes a test to create a new intangible asset of 'security access'. Kara's player narrates her sneaking up on one of the House Arcuri technicians and stealing his uniform and access pass.*

Moving the asset (subtly) into the same zone as the cannon turret represents Kara finding the right control system. Keeping the Initiative, Kara then uses the asset to make an attack on the cannon turret, accessing its controls to overload it. She makes a successful test and the cannon turret explodes in a ball of flame.

OVERCOMING AN OBSTACLE

A conflict may occur in an environment littered with obstacles, hindrances, and challenges to overcome. These obstacles are traits and don't strictly belong to any one character, but they are still problems that need to be overcome in some way.

In a physical environment, such as for a skirmish or warfare scene, these obstacles are features of the terrain: walls and similar barriers, fast-flowing water, dense mud, shifting sands, and other features that impair movement and action. During espionage or intrigue, these obstacles may represent factors that prevent access to places or people.

When you attempt to overcome an obstacle, you must describe how you are bypassing it, and then attempt a skill test. The gamemaster determines the Difficulty; this normally has a Difficulty of 1, but more challenging obstacles naturally have a higher Difficulty. Passing this test means that you've managed to pass the obstacle unhindered. Failure means that you've been stopped for the time being, and you'll need to find a different method to overcome the obstacle.

GAINING INFORMATION

Often, a situation may not be entirely as it seems, and many conflicts revolve around keeping secrets and relying on misdirection and misinformation. You're likely to find yourself in a position where you need to try and gain information during a conflict in order to win, particularly in espionage and intrigue conflicts.

WHAT IF I DON'T HAVE AN ASSET?

Assets are not only useful, they can be vital. But they are not always essential. Like any trait, they can grant options you wouldn't normally have or make a task much easier. The right tools for the right job. But unless you need one to allow the test, their use is optional, and there are many other traits and talents that might allow a character to perform an otherwise impossible action. Hyperawareness, for instance, allows a character to see the minutiae others miss, making certain advanced observation tests possible. It is important to remember that assets are just one weapon in any character's arsenal. In themselves they are only a potential key to power; opening the door is more about how they are applied and wielded.

How this is resolved can differ based on the nature of the information you seek and what you plan to do with it. Basic information-gathering is typically a Difficulty 0 skill test the skill depending on the conflict, with Momentum spent to ask the gamemaster questions about the situation. Momentum from this can also be used to create traits representing advantages gained from knowledge, or to remove traits that represented concealment or deception. You may instead seek to create an asset, or overcome an obstacle by gaining information, as noted above. The Momentum can even be saved for later if it doesn't exceed the usual limit, representing the advantage of scouting out the terrain or your opponents first.

The Difficulty of this skill test increases if there are any factors that would make the information harder to uncover. Classified, restricted, or obscure information is harder to find, while secrets may be impossible to uncover unless you know where to look or who to ask.

This form of test can be exceptionally useful for a gamemaster. Players often want to ask what their character can learn by (for instance) mingling with the guests at a party, surveying a battlefield, or asking around about their enemy. Often there isn't any specific information they can learn, but the action might yield something useful. So, a test to gain information offers a chance to build Momentum (or ask more specific questions) that represents the minor details they learned that they might turn to their advantage.

Example: Inside the facility, Kara defeats the base commander in a duel and sets about interrogating him for the information she is after. This could be run as an intrigue conflict, but the commander has already been defeated. So, the gamemaster asks Kara's player to make a *Communicate* skill test to see what she learns from the interrogation. As the commander has just been defeated, the gamemaster makes the Difficulty 0, but a more resistant captive might offer a greater Difficulty.

Kara gets three successes on her test, so she gains 3 points of Momentum. She can save this for later, making it useful information about the base and its soldiers that might aid her in her next objective. But she can also use it to ask the gamemaster questions, representing what the commander actually told her. She asks the gamemaster two questions. Satisfied with her answers, she saves the third point for later.

AIDING AN ALLY

Your character may end up in a situation where their allies are hurt or impaired in some way and you want to try and help them. These kinds of problems tend to take the form of traits or complications inflicted on characters, and removing traits from a scene is much the same as adding them.

If you wish to remove a trait, choose which trait you wish to remove and describe how you wish to get rid of it. Then, attempt a skill test, with a Difficulty of 2. If you pass, then you've managed to remove the chosen trait.

Helping a defeated ally during the scene they were defeated in works in much the same way but is somewhat more challenging. There are two ways you can go about this.

- ⦿ If the defeat would have a lasting or permanent effect (death, adding a new character trait, or some other long-lasting consequence), then you may attempt to prevent that lasting effect. Describe how you wish to aid the defeated character and attempt a skill test with a Difficulty of 2. If you pass, then the ally is still defeated, but the lasting effect is prevented: you've stabilized a dying ally, or you've helped alleviate the lasting effect, but the ally still needs time to recover and can't rejoin the scene.
- ⦿ If the defeat has no lasting or permanent effect, then you can try to recover the defeat directly. Describe how you wish to recover the defeat, and begin an extended task, with a requirement equal to 4 plus the Quality of the asset used to defeat that ally. If the extended task is completed, then the ally is no longer defeated and they may rejoin the scene.



THE FORMS OF CONFLICT

The basic system for conflict can be used for any form of conflict, from chases to intrigue to duels. We've broken the most common forms of conflict into five types: Dueling, Skirmish, Warfare, Espionage and Intrigue. These are not necessarily the only types of conflict, simply the most common ones. The following provides a more detailed and streamlined version of these rules for these particular forms of conflict.

This detail is not a series of extra rules and exceptions that make everything more complicated. Instead, it offers several examples of how the conflict system adapts to different settings. Most of the changes are narrative, detailing what the various assets and zones should represent. If anything appears confusing, refer back to the previous core system.

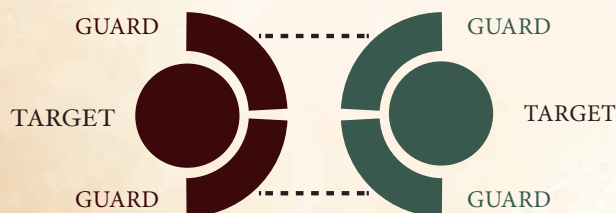
DUELING

Honor duels amongst nobility and military officers are a common way of settling disputes in the Imperium, and gladiatorial combat is a common form of public entertainment. Alongside this, skill in single combat is also useful for defending against would-be assassins. Elite schools of swordmasters—such as the Ginaz—exist to fight, and teach, combat to those who can afford them.

Most dueling is fought with swords and knives, as the widespread use of shields renders projectile weapons ineffective and energy weapons too perilous to use. Low-velocity projectile throwers remain somewhat common for ambushes and assassins, as they're useful against enemies who don't have shields, or enemies who are unprepared to fight, but they're otherwise quite rare in dueling.

ZONES IN DUELING: MANEUVER & POSITIONING

Dueling is a **single combat** between two individuals. As such, the physical environment matters somewhat less than the positioning of the combatants. Thus, each character receives a single zone which represents themselves, and two zones that represent the area immediately around them, which can be thought of as their guard, one to the left and one to the right, with one fighter's right guard zone connecting to their opponent's left guard zone (though they might equally reflect 'high' and 'low', or any pair of areas that a fighter must protect). See the example below.



Each combatant is assumed to turn to face their opponent at all times. Both combatants' assets begin the battle within their own zone, and battle is a matter of moving assets into positions to attack and defend effectively. Moving a weapon asset into the opponent's central zone and making a successful attack typically results in the target's defeat, though some prolonged bouts may require a succession of attacks (using the extended task rules).

Example: Kara is doing some combat training with Nasir. As it is one-against-one, this is a duel, so the zones are defined as the standard personal zone and two defensive zones each.

ASSETS IN DUELING: WEAPONS & DEFENSES

The assets used in dueling are, naturally, weapons and defenses.

- ✧ **Melee weapons** are the most common form of dueling asset. Blades, varying in size from swords to daggers and knives, are the most common form of melee weapons, and many combatants enter battle with more than one: a blade in each hand, and maybe some extras sheathed about their body for special circumstances. Blades are useful both on offense and defense, and swordsmanship is a complex game of feints, parries, and precision attacks. In single combat, moving a melee weapon asset represents the position the weapon has relative to both attacker and defender. A melee weapon may attack an opponent once it has been moved into that opponent's zone.
- ✧ **Subtle weapons** are essentially a specialized form of melee weapon, designed for trickery and deception rather than honest battle. Tiny needles—nearly invisible, always envenomed, often embedded in clothes—can nick or scratch unwary foes with innocuous movements. Concealed blades can be

drawn to provide a sudden advantage. Poison and drug dispensers upon weapons can turn the merest graze into a debilitating hit or leave a foe disoriented.

- ✧ **Ranged weapons** are rare in dueling, and they are used more commonly by soldiers and assassins seeking an unfair fight in their favor. They're hard to use against a shielded target—the shield stops fast-moving objects completely—but quite effective otherwise. In dueling, moving a ranged weapon asset represents moving where the weapon is pointed, and what it is aimed at. A ranged weapon may attack an opponent once the asset has been moved into that opponent's zone (that is, it's aimed at them).
- ✧ **Shields** are the primary form of personal defense for anyone of any importance. All player characters are assumed to be of sufficient standing that they can equip a personal shield if desired. Most shields protect the whole body, stopping any object moving faster than a few centimeters per second (to allow air to pass through and avoid suffocating the wearer). Some combatants employ a partial shield, or half-shield, which only covers half of their body, but which can be maneuvered around tactically. A full shield asset cannot be moved. A half-shield asset can be moved in single combat, but only to zones adjacent to the wearer's own zone. Attempting an attack in the same zone as a shield is impossible unless the attack is sufficiently slow-moving (normally from a melee weapon). Note that a shield also prevents the wearer from making ranged attacks.
- ✧ **Armor** is rare in dueling and gladiatorial combat, but it is commonly used by soldiers who may not be equipped with a shield. Those wearing shields tend to avoid armor as it hinders mobility for little benefit; the kinds of careful attack that can pierce a shield can also find the weak spots in a suit of armor (see also 'Attacks' later).

In addition, characters may seek to create intangible assets to represent an especially favorable position, or taking aim, or other temporary advantages that come about through tactics or circumstances.

Example: Kara and Nasir are both using knife assets, but to give Nasir a chance, he is wearing a shield and holding a knife in each hand. Kara only has a single blade.



ACTIONS IN DUELING

This section provides some guidance on the most common actions you're likely to attempt—or have attempted against you—during a duel. These are all explained in the **Conflict Overview** (p.167).

MOVEMENT

Moving assets in a duel reflects moving weapons and defenses to attack and defend different areas.

- ✧ Any asset worn on your character's person, or which represents their overall position or situation, is placed in the zone that represents your character. Such assets cannot be moved—they're there to protect you.
- ✧ Any asset mounted upon one of your character's arms, or held in one of their hands, begin the conflict in one or other of the zones immediately in front of them; you can choose which ones go where. These are normally weapons or tools, and they can be positioned to help defend your character or attack your opponent. Moving such an asset to the zone representing your opponent allows you to attack them with that asset.
- ✧ If you find yourself without any other weapons, you automatically receive an 'Unarmed Attack' tangible asset with a Quality of 0, allowing you to strike and grapple without the use of a weapon.
- ✧ Intangible assets which represent things you've done or are doing to your opponent—such as misdirection, or aiming a ranged weapon—can be moved around freely but are not present at the beginning of the scene; they must be created during the conflict itself.
- ✧ Moving an asset **subtly** often involves moving while the opponent's attention is elsewhere. If they're paying attention to the blade in your right hand, they may not notice you moving the blade in your left.
- ✧ Moving an asset **boldly** is often a form of misdirection, performing an obvious, dramatic action to provoke a hasty reaction; the daring thrust often serves to draw attention (and defenses) away from the slow blade. Sometimes, moving an asset represents wrestling your opponent into range of your asset rather than moving the asset to them.

Example: Kara and Nasir both begin circling each other. Nasir cannot move his shield asset, but can move either or both knives in an attempt to get an attack on Kara. He tries to keep one knife on the offensive, moving it into Kara's defense zones, but keeps one knife back in his defense zone to parry with. He uses a lot of subtle moves in case he can get in the right place to make an attack.

Kara makes a lot of bold moves, taking her blade close to Nasir's personal zone and giving her the option of moving his defensive knife out of the way (by dodging and weaving to find a gap in his guard).

ATTACKS

The following is how the **Conflict Overview** (p.167) applies to dueling:

- ✧ A dueling **asset** must be a weapon of some kind, and to defeat your opponent it must be used in the zone that represents your opponent.
- ✧ The **skill** you roll in a dueling contest is normally **Battle** for both sides; other skills are possible if there's a good reason. Creating a trait that represents an observation or insight might allow you to use Understand to attack or defend, while a trait that represents good positioning might let you use Move. The attacker's final Difficulty increases by +1 for each defensive asset in the same zone (armor, shields, and weapons being used to block or guard).
- ✧ If your successful attack leads to an extended task (meaning the foe is not a minor character), the task's requirement equals the foe's Battle skill.
- ✧ A **lasting defeat** can include death, but also covers serious injuries which have a long-term or permanent effect, such as dismemberment, disfigurement, severe organ damage, and similar.

DEFEAT

A character defeated in a duel may have surrendered (at the controlling player's discretion), been rendered unconscious, or suffered some painful but non-serious wound—something which keeps them from fighting but which won't have any real lasting impact. In a formal duel or training bout, it may simply be reaching an agreed-upon win condition such as first to draw blood.

TARGETING ASSETS

Targeting an opponent's assets is a useful way of gaining an edge. While it's next to impossible to deny a shielded or armored foe their shield or armor—as such assets are securely affixed to them—you can still remove other kinds of asset from play. In these circumstances, assets and traits are largely synonymous.

- ✧ Assets which represent weapons can be knocked from their owner's hands, allowing you to disarm your foe. They can attempt to retrieve weapons lost in this way but doing so requires an action.
- ✧ Intangible assets which represent your opponent's positioning or circumstances, or effects inflicted upon you (such as being tricked, put off-balance, or having a weapon aimed at you), can be overcome and removed from play entirely. If an opponent has a good position, you can move to deny them that. If

an enemy is aiming at your character, you can disrupt their aim. If your character is off-balance, they can regain their center and restore their balance.

CREATING A TRAIT OR ASSET

Creating traits to give your character an edge or impair your opponent can tip the balance of a fight in your favor, opening up new opportunities for you or closing off options that your opponent might have used. Similarly, creating new assets can be an important option during a conflict.

- ✧ Tangible assets must be something hidden on your character's person, and only revealed now, or they may be something improvised from the environment, such as finding an object to use as a weapon.
- ✧ Intangible assets can represent the benefits of observation, positioning, tactical ploys and tricks, and any other advantage that may come from how your character fights rather than the physical tools of combat. Alternatively, an intangible asset might be some hindrance inflicted upon an opponent, such as knocking them off-balance, creating a fake opening to lure them in, using taunts to distract or confuse them, and similar.

Example: *Kara manages to attack one of Nasir's blade assets, sending it spinning across the training floor out of reach. Nasir fails to bring his other blade back for defense and Kara presses her advantage, subtly moving her blade into Nasir's personal zone. She Keeps the Initiative to make an attack, but the shield asset increases the Difficulty by 1. She succeeds, defeating Nasir by sliding a slow blade under his throat.*

GAINING INFORMATION

Even in a one-on-one duel, knowledge is power. Being able to read an opponent's fighting style may allow you to form appropriate defenses or figure out a way of attacking that they're ill-equipped to defend against. Being observant might allow your character to detect hidden weapons or discern the signs of their ploys.

While **Understand** is the obvious choice for gaining information, the **Battle** skill can be useful in dueling for learning about an opponent's weapons and fighting style or judging how capable a fighter your opponent is.

When gathering information during a duel, you might wish to create traits that represent identifying a weakness in your foe's defenses (making it easier to attack them), or ones which represent anticipating enemy attacks, to make it harder for the enemy to attack your character. Alternatively, you may be on the lookout for information that doesn't help you during the combat at hand, but which might be helpful later. Many swordmasters swear that you can only learn who someone truly is when you fight them.

SKIRMISH

Skirmishes are combats involving a small number of individual combatants, but more than a one-on-one duel. They typically involve movement and maneuver around a small environment, attempting to overcome enemies through positioning and decisive action.

As with dueling, skirmishes are most commonly fought with swords and knives. However, low-velocity projectile throwers are somewhat common in skirmishes, often employed in an opening salvo against unprepared foes or those lacking shields.

ZONES IN SKIRMISH: MANEUVER & POSITIONING

In a skirmish between several combatants, the physical environment is important. Each combatant does not have a set of individual zones as they do in dueling. Instead, combatants maneuver around the battlefield, using the terrain and their relative positions to their advantage.

The environment of the skirmish should be divided up into zones around its features or simply to divide the open space. Individual zones may grant advantages or impose problems on the characters in them, representing terrain features.

Rather than moving assets around individually, skirmishes track the movement of individual characters, moving them using the normal rules for moving assets. Moving a knife obviously moves the character holding it as well. If an asset is in the same zone as a character or non-player character, the asset can be used to make an attack on them.

A ranged weapon can be used to attack enemies in the same zone at no penalty, or in an adjacent zone at +1 Difficulty. Moving a ranged weapon asset into another zone represents taking aim at a target in that zone; it need not mean the character themselves has moved into that zone. When moving a ranged weapon asset into another zone, the player should specify whether their character is moving with it.

Example: Kara and Nasir are set upon by some thugs in a back alley in Arrakeen. The gamemaster could make the alley a single zone, but decides to make things more interesting by creating three zones: the part of the alley near the main road (entrance), the part of the alley with a fire escape ladder (fire escape), and the end of the alley that is a dead end (end).

The end of the alley has the trait 'Dark' as it is covered and shaded. The zone with the ladder might offer opportunities to escape. Nasir and Kara begin in the entrance zone with two thugs; three thugs begin in each of the fire escape and end zones.

ASSETS IN SKIRMISH: WEAPONS & DEFENSES

The assets used in skirmish are, naturally, weapons and defenses.

- ⊕ **Weapons** and most defensive assets work in the same way as they do in dueling. However, as each combatant is a single target and not a collection of zones, any attack allows the target to apply all their defensive assets. A weapon used to attack can't be used to parry in the same round. The gamemaster may also decide other defenses can't be brought to bear depending on circumstances.
- ⊕ **Shields** work in the same way as in dueling, except that ranged attacks against half-shields increase in Difficulty by +2 instead. Melee attacks against shielded foes increase in Difficulty by +1.
- ⊕ **Armor** is sometimes used by soldiers and other combatants who may not be equipped with a shield. Those wearing shields tend to avoid armor as it hinders mobility for little benefit; the kinds of careful attack that can pierce a shield can also find the weak spots in a suit of armor. Armor makes attacks against the wearer more difficult, with heavier armor providing a bigger Difficulty increase, but it also increases the complication range of actions relating to movement and maneuvering by the same amount.
- ⊕ **Intangible assets** can represent an especially favorable position, taking advantage of cover, taking aim, or other temporary advantages that come about through tactics or circumstances.

Example: Kara pulls her knife and Nasir takes out a maula pistol. The thugs also all pull knives. Kara and Nasir really wish they'd worn their shields.

ACTIONS IN SKIRMISH

This section provides some guidance on the most common actions you're likely to attempt—or have attempted against you—during a skirmish. These are all explained in the **Conflict Overview** (p.167), but here we've provided some context that is specific to skirmishes for how to use and interpret those actions.

MOVEMENT

In a skirmish, you do not move your assets individually. Rather, movement actions move your character around the battlefield.

- ⊕ Ordinary movement allows you to move to any adjacent zone. This can be thought of as a standard



walking pace, or normal wary movement around a combat environment. Spending 2 points of Momentum to move an additional zone represents moving more quickly: a quick dash or run. You may instead spend 2 points of Momentum to allow one of your allies to move to an adjacent zone; the ally must be able to see or hear you, and they take the opportunity to move at your signal.

- ⦿ Anyone in the same zone as any other character is considered a viable target. Anyone not in the same zone can only be attacked with ranged weapons.
- ⦿ Moving **subtly** often involves moving stealthily or snatching the opportunity to move when an opponent is distracted or looking elsewhere. This opportune movement allows you to continue acting before the enemy can respond.
- ⦿ Moving **boldly** is overt, dramatic, and attention-grabbing, often accompanied by a shout or war-cry that might drive a foe away in sudden fear, or a taunt that draws out a chosen foe.
- ⦿ A failed attempt to move subtly or boldly allows a single enemy to move to an adjacent zone.

ATTACKS, DEFEAT, AND USING ASSETS

While the zones may be different, skirmish attacks work in the same way as dueling attacks. The same options exist to target assets, create new assets, and defeat opponents. However, the options for defeat may be less formal.

Example: Kara acts first. With no need to move an asset, she slashes at one of the thugs in the same zone as she and Nasir. As the thug is a minor non-player character, and Kara wins a contested test, he drops. On their turn, one of the thugs from another zone attempts to move into Kara's, but he fails, so Kara holds him at bay. Nasir drops the other thug in their zone with his pistol in another contested test.

The thugs press their attack, looking to move more of them into the entrance zone to overwhelm Kara and Nasir. While Kara dispatches more as they enter her zone, with numbers on their side it isn't long before all the thugs are in the entrance zone targeting Kara and Nasir.

In the next round the thugs make a point of targeting Nasir. As he is a player character it takes an extended test to take Nasir down, but a concerted attempt from the thugs nearly does so. As they are

all performing essentially the same action, all their attacks on Nasir count to the same extended track.

Nasir uses his action to move to a different zone. The thugs close in on Kara, but she manages to hold her own. Nasir can try and shoot thugs attacking Kara but with +1 to Difficulty for attacking an adjacent zone with a ranged weapon. As he is not sure of his skill, he moves his maula pistol asset into Kara's zone. Nasir can opt not to move with the asset, because this is a ranged weapon and he is aiming. If he moved subtly, he might keep the initiative and give Kara a chance to fell one of them.

Instead, he moves boldly and is able to move one of the thugs out of Kara's zone, either shooting to force the thug to step back or intimidating him with his pistol.

With most of the thugs down, the skirmish ends as the remainder make a run for it.

OVERCOMING AN OBSTACLE

The environment where a skirmish happens can be as vital for victory or defeat as the combatants. Individual zones may contain obstacles that are difficult to move over, around, or past, or which otherwise get in the way of fighting.

The majority of skill tests to overcome an obstacle use **Move**; the obstacles may be an area of difficult terrain

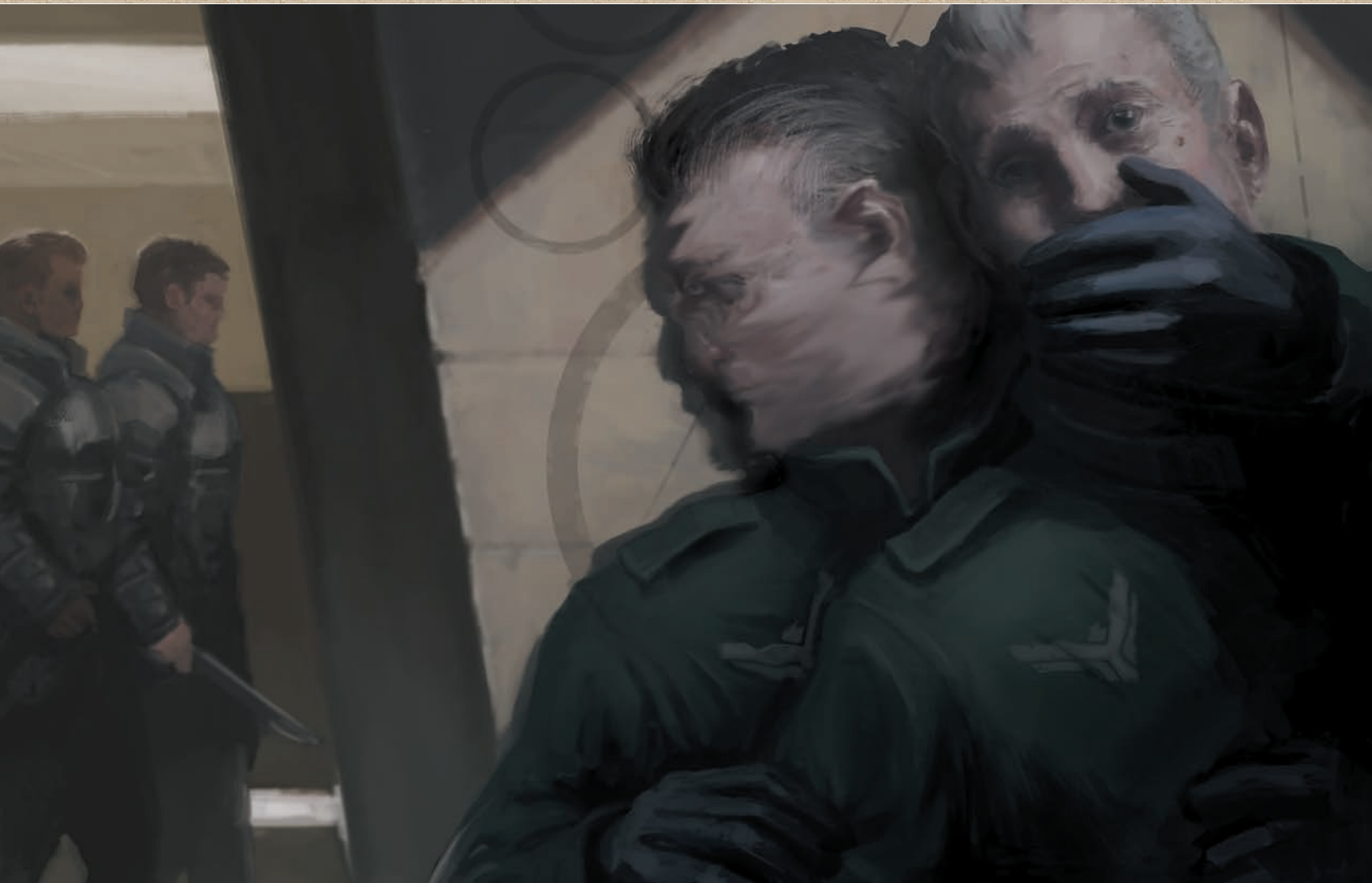
that may slow your character down or ensnare them, or there's a hard barrier that cannot be crossed without effort. It may be possible to use **Understand**, representing trying to discern an easy path through or past the obstacle, or to use **Discipline** to simply force your character through with grit and fortitude.

GAINING INFORMATION

Even in a skirmish, knowledge is power. Being able to read an opponent's fighting style may allow you to form appropriate defenses or figure out a way of attacking that they're ill-equipped to defend against. Being observant might allow your character to detect hidden weapons or discern the signs of their ploys. It may also be useful for spotting useful details about the environment around your character—spotting escape routes, useful objects or items, precarious or dangerous terrain, and similar.

While **Understand** is the obvious choice for gaining information, the **Battle** skill can be useful in a skirmish for learning about an opponent's weapons and fighting style or judging how capable a fighter your opponent is.

Creating new traits in a skirmish follows the same pattern as that for dueling, detailing the weaknesses of your opponent. But it might also create new hazards in the environment.



ESPIONAGE

Knowledge is power. And knowledge of your enemies is especially potent. Anyone in a position of power is aware of the value of knowledge and the power of secrets. It should come as no surprise that most Houses cultivate a network of spies, informants, and surveillance methods to ensure that they know everything worth knowing, and that they also take precautions to protect their own secrets from prying eyes.

ZONES IN ESPIONAGE: SOCIAL GROUPS AND SECURE PLACES

When resolving an espionage scene, the zones used are somewhat abstract in nature. Each zone represents a person, a group of people, or a place. The links between these zones are the natural connections between them: a zone representing a particular group of smugglers may have a link to someone who does business with them, and links to the places those smugglers regularly do business. Each of these links should denote the nature of the connection. A small example is below.



What defines each zone is that each is a potential source of information or is connected to one.

One element that makes espionage zones unusual is that they may be unknown to the players: a map might only show the zones and links the player characters are aware of, and it may require time and effort (and actions) to reveal links and zones which were previously hidden. Thus, an espionage scene is a process of information-gathering, attempting to discover a way to obtain a crucial secret, or to protect such secrets from being uncovered. These hidden connections are normally revealed—or sometimes created—through actions taken by characters, using assets moved into those zones.

At times, a zone may instead represent an event—a gathering or meeting of some sort. Events only occur at a particular time and a particular place, but they can provide a rare connection between groups or people

who are normally unconnected. As they're time-sensitive, they may vanish after a few turns, though recurring events may appear and disappear on a schedule. Needless to say, it can be vital to learn of an event before it happens.

ASSETS IN ESPIONAGE: SPIES AND SECURITY

The assets used in espionage are normally spies and security measures, but there are other forms of asset.

- ❖ **Spies** are highly trained operatives who use stealth, deception, and other covert means to gather information. Most spies divide their efforts between obtaining information themselves—using fake identities, disguises, and similar methods—and building a network of informants of their own. Spies also watch for the activities of opposing spies. However, true spies are a rare and precious resource, and one that should not be squandered. Moving a spy into a zone represents an attempt to infiltrate that particular group or place, or to get into the presence or confidence of that person. Spies can create informant assets and place surveillance devices.
- ❖ **Informants** are generally less capable, and less mobile, than spies, but they are often already well-placed within a location or group, or within the confidence of a person. Informants are normally created through bribery or extortion. Servants make excellent informants, as they often are privy to their masters' secrets while being considered beneath notice. Moving an informant is the same as moving a spy, but informants typically have a lower Quality and thus less ability to move around.
- ❖ **Surveillance devices** which record sounds and images can be invaluable espionage tools, allowing information to be gathered without the presence of a person. They require the correct placement to be used effectively, and they cannot be moved afterward without being physically retrieved (which also recovers any information they've gathered). They're hard to find, but if they are discovered, the information they've gathered is lost.
- ❖ **Security measures** are the antithesis of espionage, and any House makes full use of every method available to keep spies out. Security measures range from guards and sentries—infantry soldiers, normally warfare assets—to physical security such as reinforced walls, locks, penta-shield doors, no-rooms, and similar. Mobile security, such as guards, can be moved around to actively search for spies, informants, and surveillance devices (and question people, for more overt information-gathering), while static security measures are passive and only serve to present an obstacle.

You may also seek to create intangible assets that represent rumors, information leaks, or propaganda that undermines, misleads, or disrupts the enemy. On the defensive side of things, you may use information about suspected spies, additional security procedures such as random patrols or searches, or other actions undertaken by your security measures as a form of intangible asset.

Example: *Kara has been sent to investigate a spice smuggling operation. All she knows is that it is based on Arrakis. An investigation gets her a clue that the smugglers are trading with a particular group of Fremen.*

Posing as a spice dealer, she makes connections with the Fremen that lets her contact with the smugglers. Eventually she infiltrates the group deep enough to learn who is running the organization. However, she could have come at this from any zone. If she were a Fremen, she might have found something going on with the tribe. She might even have run into the leader and become suspicious enough to try and find out what he was up to.

ACTIONS IN ESPIONAGE

This section provides some guidance on the most common actions you're likely to attempt—or have attempted against your character—during espionage scenes. These are all explained in the **Conflict Overview** (p.167), but here we've provided some context that is specific to espionage for how to use and interpret those actions.

MOVEMENT

Moving assets in espionage reflects moving agents and security apparatus to the places and people where they're the most useful. It represents spies and similar assets moving under instructions from their handlers—the player characters—often over a protracted period of time.

- ✧ Assets are capable of observing or protecting the zone they are in, so moving them around is a necessary part of getting the desired information or securing your House's secrets.
- ✧ Surveillance devices cannot be moved once set.
- ✧ Security measure assets protect a zone by making it harder to enter that zone, with the protection provided having a rating equal to the security measure's Quality.
- ✧ When you attempt to move a spy asset, compare the spy's Quality with the highest-rated security measures of the zone they are moving to. If the security measures have a higher Quality, the spy asset cannot enter that zone without attempting to move subtly or boldly.
- ✧ The Difficulty of skill tests to move a spy asset subtly or boldly increase by +1 for each security measure in place in the destination zone.
- ✧ Active security measures—guards and similar—can be moved around freely.

- ✧ Moving an asset **subtly** should be fairly commonplace in espionage—stealth and guile are part of the process after all—and getting assets into position quietly has the obvious advantage of preventing the enemy from being able to react to you. Defensively, moving security measures secretly may catch enemy spies off-guard.
- ✧ Moving an asset **boldly** may not seem appropriate for espionage, but it can have value. Actions that draw attention in a particular way can create distractions and provoke responses, and a bold action doesn't need to be loud and visible to everyone... in espionage, it just needs to be noticed by an opposing spymaster. Defensively, moving security measures in an overt and dramatic manner may just lure enemy spies into making a deadly mistake.
- ✧ If your character is inclined to engage in espionage more directly—perhaps because they are a spy themselves—they may do so, treating themselves as a spy asset. For these purposes, their Quality is the lowest of their Understand and Move, minus four. This may also produce opportunities for skirmishes and dueling scenes if the character is targeted.

ATTACKS

Direct attacks should be relatively rare in an espionage conflict, because they turn the situation from spying to assassination, as you target an opposing character or try to avoid your own character being targeted. However, more subtle attacks are still an option.

The following is how the **Conflict Overview** (p.167) applies to espionage:

- ✧ As mentioned above under **Assets in Espionage: Spies and Security**, assets in espionage are usually things like spies, informants, surveillance devices, and intangible assets like rumors and propaganda.
- ✧ The **skill** you roll in an espionage contest is normally **Move** for you, to get close enough to strike; your opponent may use **Discipline** or **Understand** to represent their awareness.
- ✧ If you fail your contest, the gamemaster may rule that the scene is now a skirmish or duel.
- ✧ If your successful attack leads to an extended task (meaning the foe is not a minor character), the task's requirement depends on how your foe would resist your attack—likely **Discipline** or **Understand**.
- ✧ A **lasting defeat** from assassination is much the same as one from dueling. Results include death, but also cover serious injuries which have a long-term or permanent effect, such as dismemberment, disfigurement, severe organ damage, and the like.

Example: *As part of her attempt to discover more about the spice smuggling operation's leaders, Kara attempts to*

place a surveillance device in the operation. She might do this by bugging one of the smugglers or placing a device in one of their facilities or ships. In game terms, though, she is moving a surveillance device asset into the smuggling operation zone.

She is successful in moving the asset, but she needs to use it to learn anything. The gamemaster can set a base Difficulty, but if Kara is trying to learn about a particular person the roll might be contested by that person's skills. The surveillance device in the right zone is what allows her to make the test, so it can't help her with the Difficulty. There is also a surveillance countermeasure asset in the zone protecting the smugglers and adding +1 to the Difficulty.

Kara spends Momentum, representing long hours poring over data, and luckily makes a successful test. The gamemaster gives her some information about the leader of the group to help move her investigation forward, but she can also use Momentum to ask some additional questions she may have overheard the answers to.

DEFEAT

Espionage often leaves little trace, sometimes not even a body. The consequences of defeat can vary wildly depending on the plot. Usually, victory simply means that one agent has acquired the intelligence they were after, and if they do really well their enemies won't even know they have it.

TARGETING ASSETS

It can be useful to try and sabotage the assets of your opponent during an espionage scene. This involves eliminating or exposing enemy spies and informants, disabling surveillance devices, and undermining security measures.

- ✧ Targeting spies results in the spy being removed from play, but not eliminated. They've been exposed, and need to withdraw and go into hiding to establish new cover identities and rebuild connections, which takes time and effort.
- ✧ Targeting informants exposes them, but as they tend to lack the support networks of spies, they're normally captured and executed by their masters. Naturally, this means that they're destroyed.
- ✧ Targeting surveillance devices destroys them or renders them useless. Once their presence is known, they can no longer provide valuable information. Spending 2 points of Momentum to create a trait 'Subverted Surveillance' (or something similar) may allow you to use a discovered surveillance device to spread disinformation.
- ✧ Targeting security measures does not destroy or disable them, but rather creates a way for your assets to bypass them: a bribed guard, a hidden way through the walls, a way to unlock a door, etc. This renders the asset ineffective, at least until the breach is discovered and closed (recovering the asset).

CREATING A TRAIT OR ASSET

Creating traits can help shape the landscape in espionage, creating options, opportunities, and connections that may not have existed before.

- ✧ A created trait may lay the groundwork for other actions later, such as establishing an alias or cover story to make it easier to bypass security later.
- ✧ A trait can also be used, with the right justification for how it is created, to connect one zone to another. Once connected, two zones count as adjacent, allowing your character access (or easier access) to a person or place you had little or no access to before.
- ✧ The most common forms of tangible asset created for espionage are informants and surveillance devices. An informant functions just like a spy, though they're normally less capable and somewhat disposable. Surveillance devices can gather information remotely and be very difficult to find, but they cannot really move between zones.
- ✧ Intangible assets can represent the uncontrolled spread of information, true or otherwise, which can help influence how the opposition acts or reacts. Similarly, you can create additional intangible assets to represent actions undertaken by active security, such as additional patrols or tighter procedures, bolstering the security measures present in a zone.

OVERCOMING AN OBSTACLE

Obstacles in espionage are not typically physical obstructions so much as social or political ones. Secretive or isolated factions may be difficult or impossible for an asset to reach under normal circumstances, even if connections exist.

Overcoming such obstacles typically requires work establishing legitimate—or seemingly-legitimate—reasons for access, such as an asset proving themselves worthy or useful to an isolated group who shun outsiders, or obtaining letters of introduction or some other reason to reach a reclusive but powerful individual.

These typically require **Communicate** or **Understand** tests, but tests of worth may require **Battle**, **Move**, or **Discipline** tests depending on the nature of the group you're seeking to access.

GAINING INFORMATION

Information is the point of espionage, so naturally this action is undertaken frequently during espionage scenes.

You may only gather information from a zone where you have a spy, informant, or surveillance device asset present. Getting such assets into position is the central challenge of espionage. In addition, the Difficulty of any skill tests made to gather information is increased by +1 for each security measure asset the opponent has in that zone, as their presence is a hindrance.

Understand is the skill used for most information-gathering actions in espionage, as that is the skill most applicable to obtaining and processing knowledge. Other skills may be applicable, but only in specific circumstances where the skill relates to the kinds of information being gathered.

Some information may not be obtained easily, requiring that it be actively retrieved from people rather than gathered passively from written records or simple observation. This, naturally, becomes a **contest** against the character being questioned (which obviously cannot be done by a surveillance device). Attempting to question a character without revealing a spy's nature is more difficult for the spy but tends to avoid some of

the nastier consequences. Alternatively, converting a well-placed non-player character into a double agent can be extremely valuable, but difficult, likely requiring an **extended task** (with a requirement equal to the non-player character's **Discipline**) and some way of persuading them to betray their masters.

Other information may take time and effort over a prolonged period to obtain, requiring an extended task to complete. This may even require working toward the task in different locations or from different people, piecing together information from multiple sources, with all the challenges that ensue in getting from location to location

WARFARE

War in the Imperium is both a constant threat and also heavily regulated. Most Houses maintain a standing army of some sort, and many can supplement this with mercenary companies and other unscrupulous types. However, war has rules. Some methods—such as the use of atomics or equivalent destructive forces—on human populations will make enemies of the entire Landsraad, who are quick to enforce breaches of the rules of warfare, and the proper conduct of war between Houses is serious business.

On a single world, individual Minor Houses may war amongst one another, so long as the Major House that rules over them permits it, and Major Houses may use their own forces to put down rebellious and seditious

elements within their own domains. Major Houses cannot so easily war with one another, for moving armies between worlds requires the consent of the Spacing Guild, who charge a hefty fee for their services.

ZONES IN WARFARE: MANEUVER & TERRAIN

Warfare is similar to a skirmish, but on a much larger scale. When resolving a warfare scene, zones represent locations of strategic importance. The gate to a city, a main road, a defensible hilltop, a valuable mine or factory, an airfield or spaceport, a command bunker... all of these could be



zones in Warfare. The key is to denote the places where fighting is likely to take place, and when armies march to war, they fight over places of importance.

Individual locations often have some benefit or advantage they provide to whomever holds them, or represent something which is valuable to the possessor. A gateway may be one of the few pathways into a city, while a main road may be the fastest route from one place to another. A mine or factory may simply be valuable, while an airfield or spaceport may allow the possessor to mobilize ornithopters and other aircraft more easily, and a command bunker may contain senior officers or even members of the enemy House.

Similarly, some locations may pose problems: terrain may impair the advance of troops and vehicles or leave occupying forces vulnerable to attack. Some locations may only have an effect for one side or another: defending forces may know the local terrain better and be able to take advantage of it in ways that invaders cannot.

The player characters themselves may or may not be directly involved in warfare. Some characters may choose to lead their forces personally (in which case, they move with whichever asset represents the unit they lead), while others may be content to give their orders from the safety of a command bunker or fortified war room.

At the start of the battle, an objective that will lead to victory must be set. This might be something like control of a particular zone (such as 'control of the Arrakeen Residency'). The objective is usually the same for each side,

but some battles are fought over several objectives, with each side having to protect something as well as trying to take control of something their opponents have.

Example: *On a deserted moon, House Molay and House Arcuri have come to blows over a mining deposit. The area is divided into five zones, one of which is the mining deposit's richest site. Kara is leading the Molay forces, which have been landed in one zone. The Arcuri forces are in another. Whoever can secure the mining deposits zone or destroy the opposing force's assets first will be the victor.*

ASSETS IN WARFARE: ARMED FORCES AND FORTIFICATIONS

Assets used in warfare are armed forces and fortifications.

- ✪ **Infantry** form the bulk of any armed force, and squads or platoons of infantry are a common form of asset. Infantry may be armed and equipped in a few different ways, from lightly equipped commando units, to armored heavy infantry carrying heavier weaponry. They normally carry a mixture of blades and projectile weapons, with occasional use of lasguns if the enemy is likely to lack shields. Shielded infantry fight exclusively with blades, as their shields stop their own projectile weapons as surely as an enemy's. Infantry fight at relatively close ranges, and thus can only attack other assets in the same zone.



- ⊕ **Ground vehicles** are another vital part of armed forces. An armored groundcar can withstand greater punishment than infantry, and travel more quickly or more reliably over rough terrain. Ground vehicles are normally used for reconnaissance and transport, though they are occasionally fitted with heavier weaponry when the enemy lacks shields. Shielded ground vehicles, naturally, don't carry weaponry, though they do need to deactivate their shields for passengers to embark or disembark or for cargo to be loaded or unloaded. Ground vehicles can carry infantry assets around the battlefield.
- ⊕ **Aircraft** are used in many of the same ways as ground vehicles—as scouts and transports—though they tend to be faster and have the advantage of altitude. This also means that anything transported in an aircraft (such as an ornithopter) is far less likely to survive if the craft is destroyed, though a shielded ornithopter has little to fear until it comes time to take on or disgorge passengers or cargo. Aircraft can move significantly faster than ground forces, moving one additional zone with each move.
- ⊕ **Fortifications** are stationary defenses, such as walls and obstacles, that prevent an enemy from moving into or through an area, or which provide cover and protection for defending troops (or both). The simplest kinds of fortifications are earthworks which can be hastily constructed by troops in the field, while the most potent are House shields that can protect a palace or castle from attack. Obviously, the more powerful the fortification, the more costly it is to construct or obtain, and fortifications cannot be moved.

In addition, characters may seek to create intangible assets to represent ambushes, tactical ploys, special knowledge given to (or discovered by) specific units, and so forth.

Example: *Kara herself is in a command shuttle and intends to stay there to direct the battle. For assets she has several tanks, soldier assault teams, and ornithopters. She starts moving the ornithopters in as they are 'Fast', to claim the objective area first, bringing the tanks and soldiers up behind them for support.*

ACTIONS IN WARFARE

Below you'll find guidance on the most common actions you're likely to attempt—or have attempted against your character—during warfare. These are all explained in the **Conflict Overview** (p.167), but here we've provided some context that is specific to warfare scenes for how to use and interpret those actions.

MOVEMENT

In warfare, each asset represents a military unit of some sort, and moving them around represents deploying them to different positions and maneuvering them around a battlefield. Units move at the behest of your character's orders and instructions, either conveyed in person or transmitted using radio or similar technologies.

- ⊕ When you begin a warfare scene, you must declare where on the battlefield your character is. Some player characters may prefer to operate from relative safety, far behind the front lines, while others wish to lead from the front. If ever an allied asset moves from your character's current zone, you may choose to move your character with it if you wish.
- ⊕ When you make a skill test to move or use an asset and your character is in the same zone as that unit, you may reduce the Difficulty of that skill test by 1 (to a minimum of 1), to represent the advantages of leading your forces directly.
- ⊕ When you make a skill test to move an asset and your character is not in the same zone as it, you may reduce the normal Momentum cost to move further or move a second asset to 1, to represent the bigger picture perspective you gain from maintaining a distance.
- ⊕ Some assets are noted as immobile, often representing defenses, fortifications, and similar emplaced positions. These assets can be used, but they cannot move.
- ⊕ Some assets might be noted as 'Fast'; these are often aircraft like ornithopters, or high-speed groundcars. Whenever a fast asset is moved, you may move it one additional zone.
- ⊕ Moving **subtly** involves commanding a unit to move stealthily or taking the opportunity to move when the enemy is distracted or looking elsewhere. The opportune movement allows you to redeploy and take further action before the enemy can respond.
- ⊕ Moving **boldly** is overt, dramatic, and attention-grabbing, drawing attention that provokes a response immediately.

ATTACKS

The following is how the **Conflict Overview** (p.167) applies to warfare:

- ⊕ As mentioned above under **Assets: Armed Forces and Fortifications**, assets in warfare are larger in scale than a skirmish, representing such battlefield elements as soldiers, vehicles, and fortifications.
- ⊕ The **skill** you roll in a warfare contest is normally **Battle** for both sides; other skills are possible if there's a good reason. The attacker's final Difficulty increases by +1 for each additional allied asset in the same zone.

- ✧ If your successful attack leads to an extended task (meaning the foe is not a minor character), the task's requirement equals the foe's Battle skill.
- ✧ A **lasting defeat** means massive casualties and such a catastrophic loss of morale that the asset may be impossible to recover.

Example: *The ornithopters reach the deposit zone first, granting Kara defensive assets in the zone and making it harder for the Arcuri forces to claim it. Then battle is joined by the heavier tank assets from both sides.*

Unfortunately, while the Arcuri forces are not as fast, they are more dangerous. Kara loses most of her tanks in the exchange as the Arcuri forces target them.

DEFEAT

Battles are not usually decided just on which army destroys the other (although that also works). To win a warfare conflict, one side needs to take control of an agreed objective. This is usually a strategic zone, the control of which grants the power both sides seek to claim. What this objective is should be set at the start of the battle; all sides in the conflict are aware of it as they all know what they are trying to achieve. If one side claims the objective and the other has no assets left in play (or that they wish to engage with), the battle is over and the loser must accept the consequences.

An asset defeated in warfare has suffered casualties and is withdrawn from battle. With some effort, they can be rallied and brought back into the fight, though with a Quality one less than normal due to casualties and reduced morale.

Example: *Having lost a significant part of her forces, Kara's ornithopters can't hope to hold on to the deposit zone against the Arcuri tanks. But while the Arcuri command shuttle is as far away as Kara's, it isn't much distance for an ornithopter to cross. She moves the ornithopters straight to the enemy command shuttle and opens fire on it.*

With the Arcuri tanks too far to protect it, the shuttle is forced to leave the zone. Kara moves her tanks into the deposit zone and waits for Arcuris' next move. With their command shuttle damaged and Molay tanks now in the objective zone, they decide to retreat and regroup, but only for now.

TARGETING ASSETS

Warfare revolves around targeting and defeating assets, and the system for doing so is the same. However, more assets may be in play at any given time. The gamemaster may insist that especially important assets be removed with a contested roll instead, as they have more protection.

CREATING A TRAIT OR ASSET

Creating traits to give you an edge or impair your opponent can tip the balance of a fight in your favor, opening

up new opportunities for you or closing off options that your opponent might have used. Similarly, creating new assets can be an important option during a conflict.

- ✧ **Tangible assets** may be emerging from a hidden position on the battlefield, or they may be reinforcements arriving from afar.
- ✧ **Intangible assets** can represent the benefits of observation, positioning, tactical ploys and tricks, and any other advantage that may come from how your character fights rather than the physical tools of combat. Intangible assets can also represent misinformation given to the enemy, such as incorrect intelligence about the positioning of assets.

OVERCOMING AN OBSTACLE

The battlefield can be as vital for victory or defeat as the combatants. Individual zones may contain obstacles and terrain features that are difficult to move over, around, or past, or which otherwise get in the way of fighting.

- ✧ **Battle**, **Communicate**, and **Discipline** can all serve as ways to coordinate and motivate military forces to maneuver through or clear out an obstacle.
- ✧ **Move** can be used to lead by example, guiding a unit through the terrain with personal experience.
- ✧ **Understand** relies on studying information from scouts to find the effective routes through an obstacle.

GAINING INFORMATION

In war, knowledge is power. Obtaining accurate information about enemy movements and dispositions is a vital part of commanding an army. This typically relies on scouts and reconnaissance operations, who can gather and relay information.

In a warfare scene, you must select an allied asset when gathering information. You may gather information about anything within their current zone or an adjacent zone, as that asset performs scouting and recon missions.

While **Understand** is the obvious choice for processing this information, the **Battle** skill can be useful in warfare for judging the strength of enemy forces based on their armament and disposition, and for spotting enemy strategies unfold. Similarly, **Communicate** can be valuable when trying to decipher intercepted enemy communications.

When gathering information during warfare, you might wish to create traits that represent identifying a weakness in enemy defenses (making it easier to attack them), or ones which represent anticipating enemy attacks, to make it harder for the enemy to attack your character.

INTRIGUE

Subtle battles of status, wits, words, and secrets, intrigue is perhaps one of the most difficult forms of conflict to visualize, but also one of the most rewarding to play out. Intrigue is an inevitable part of power and politics, with status, influence, and more tangible resources at stake. Everyone who takes part in intrigue has something to gain and everything to lose, and even those at the very top of society—the Padishah Emperor, the Spacing Guild, CHOAM, and the subtle Bene Gesserit—must play this game carefully.

Intrigue is a social conflict and so bears some similarity with espionage. But in truth it is closer to warfare, using generally intangible rather than tangible assets. Like warfare it should have an objective, which might be control of an area of an intangible zone (an area of politics, a favor or deal) or just the capitulation of an enemy.

PHYSICAL ENVIRONMENTS

It may be useful, in some social scenes, to think about the physical environment rather than social connections; you may be describing a social gathering such as a party, a diplomatic conference, or something similar.

These function in much the same way as environments described in the **Skirmish** section, though they are typically more comfortable. Each zone is likely to be a different room, though especially large chambers may be divided into multiple zones at the gamemaster's discretion. Characters can move between these zones freely—though there may be locked doors or guards barring access to some areas—and unless you are deliberately trying to be discreet, any character in the same zone as you can hear the conversations you have. This does mean that finding a quiet, isolated place to have a private conversation can be important.

ZONES IN INTRIGUE: PERSONAL AND POLITICAL CONNECTIONS

The zones in an intrigue scene are the people and groups involved. This can be very simple, with one zone for each individual participant, or more complex as factions such as Houses, and the interconnected web of loyalties and rivalries, come into play.

In the simplest cases, it should be sufficient to create one zone for each person involved in that particular intrigue. This might be the people in a specific location at a particular time, such as a society party, a meeting, or similar gathering, or it might simply be all the people vying for power and influence in a particular region of a planet, or within the courts of a Major House which commands your own. Your character is considered to be adjacent to any zone which represents someone they can communicate with in some way: speaking directly, sending messages, etc. If your character is unable to communicate with someone—perhaps their underlings or allies serve as intermediaries—they do not count as adjacent to that person's zone.

As the number of people involved in intrigue grows, the intrigue itself grows more complicated. Grouping individuals into factions and allegiances is often the first step here, creating hard connections between those aligned people to represent their shared interests (and meaning that, if your character can influence one, that can be a way to reach others in that group who might be hard to get to otherwise). Additionally, new zones may be added to the map whenever needed to represent new participants or parties who weren't involved before but are now (such as someone calling on allies to support them).

Example: Kara wants to find some leverage on a spice merchant she thinks may be cheating her House. So, she puts together a list of people to investigate and potentially manipulate and makes them zones. The zones she collects are: the spice merchant, her husband, her business partner, and her secretary. Kara may add more if her investigation brings other people to her attention.

DISPOSITION AND DESIRE

A couple of extra considerations for intrigue are disposition (what is the relationship between your character and someone else) and desire (what does each person want). These factors can often influence how characters choose to interact with the people in an intrigue (and the zones that represent them). These might not always be immediately visible, and part of the intrigue may be to discover who hates whom, who is secretly working with whom, and what everyone wants.



A character or group has a **disposition** of Allied, Friendly, Neutral, Unfriendly, or Opposed, which modifies the Difficulty of attempts to influence them by the amounts shown on the table below. Disposition is always that character/group's stance toward the player characters and their House.

DISPOSITION	MODIFIER
Allied	–2 Difficulty (minimum 0)
Friendly	–1 Difficulty (minimum 0)
Neutral	No effect
Unfriendly	+1 Difficulty
Opposed	+2 Difficulty

Disposition is not fixed and should change over time as a result of various actions. You may attempt to improve the disposition of others if you help them get something they want. You might worsen the disposition of others if you help their rivals or enemies, if you claim something they wanted, or if you do something that causes problems for them.

Noting the **desire** of a zone (whether it represents a person or group) works alongside this. Much like a player character's ambition, this represents what that person or that group wants to achieve or obtain. This both guides the actions of that person or group (it's a roleplaying prompt for the gamemaster), and is something valuable for the player characters to learn, because it allows them to influence that person or group more easily. A desire should be a short statement of intent and it doesn't have any numerical value.

Example: As Kara has had dealings with the spice merchant before, her starting disposition is unfriendly. However, Kara has met the spice merchant's husband before at a party and they got on very well, so his disposition is friendly. Kara doesn't know the others, and her House has no connection to them either, so their disposition is neutral.

Kara decides to focus on the husband first.

ASSETS IN INTRIGUE: TRADE AND SECRETS

The assets used in intrigue are typically things which can be used or traded to gain an advantage or exert influence. Many of these assets are intangible, representing information learned or rumors circulated (and the potential for extortion, knowledge trading, and similar activities), while tangible assets may represent valuable items such as precious goods, raw materials, land, or hard evidence. However, as your character rarely has those items on their person, the difference between tangible and intangible assets is far less

meaningful in intrigue, and you may wish to use this to your advantage by creating intangible assets that represent things your character *claims* to possess.

Moving an intrigue asset into another zone allows you to confront that person with the asset, perhaps to offer it as a gift, to propose a trade, or to try and threaten or coerce them. The asset is considered to be leverage, which allows your character to influence someone else, whether positively (the ability to help that person), negatively (the ability to harm that person or take something from them), or through the status quo (appealing to social standards and norms, religious drives, or the target's reputation).

✧ **Knowledge** is the basic currency of intrigue. Knowing something that your opponents don't gives you power, especially if you know things about your opponents that they don't want known. Trading secrets can be a useful way to gain influence.

✧ **Rumors and lies** are similar to knowledge, but fake. They are easy to create and can be powerful if well-used... but they're also risky. Finding a rumor and assuming that it's true can lead to mistakes, while spreading lies which are found to be false can worsen the disposition of others. Rumors and lies always appear like knowledge when first encountered, but they can be investigated to determine if they are true.

✧ **Valuables** are physical items of worth. Money, manufactured goods, precious materials (and any useful material is precious if you have enough of it), land, population, ships, mercenaries, and anything else which has both physical presence and worth. Contracts—such as trade deals, agreements with other parties, and similar sources of potential wealth—can also be considered valuables. Valuables are often traded for other things, either other valuables, or for knowledge.

Example: Kara targets the husband first to see what she can find out. She creates an asset 'Suspicious Rumor' and brings it into the husband's zone. Using this to get the husband to confide (as part of a roleplaying scene) Kara is told the husband is concerned his wife is having an affair. Having confirmed Kara's suspicions, the gamemaster gives Kara the asset 'Rumor of an Affair'.

ACTIONS IN INTRIGUE

In this section you'll find guidance for common actions you're likely to attempt—or have attempted against your character—during intrigue scenes. These are all explained in the **Conflict Overview** (p.167), but here we've provided some context that is specific to intrigue for how to use and interpret those actions.

MOVEMENT

Assets in intrigue are sources of leverage and things which can be traded to gain an advantage during social interactions. Moving an asset to a character's zone represents putting that leverage or those valuables into a position where they can be used, mentioning or alluding to knowledge your character has or resources they possess in conversation.

- ✧ Moving assets in intrigue is relatively uncomplicated, as any individual your character can talk to directly (or any group where they can speak to a representative) counts as an adjacent zone you can move assets into.
- ✧ Moving an asset **subtly** can represent using innuendo, subtlety, and implication to bring that asset into the conversation, creating a situation where your opponent may not know what you're implying until it's too late.
- ✧ Moving an asset **boldly** is the use of direct, forceful language and mannerisms to bring the asset into the conversation, with the intent of compelling an immediate, hasty response from your opponent.

ATTACKS

Direct attacks should be relatively rare in intrigue, but where they represent physical attacks in other forms of conflict, they represent a social attack in intrigue—an attempt to diminish or destroy someone's social influence in order to prevent them from meaningfully taking part in the intrigue.

In an intrigue attack, it's important to describe *how* your character is attacking the target. The attack doesn't always require interacting with the character directly; rather, it can represent a concerted effort to shame and disgrace the target character, often by spreading rumors, revealing unpleasant information about them, or attempting to provoke a disgraceful act from the target. It may also represent blackmailing the target to get them to back down willingly, or it may be a process of undermining the target's resources and the sources of their influence.

The following is how the **Conflict Overview** (p.167) applies to intrigue:

- ✧ Many assets used in an intrigue attack are intangible, such as knowledge and rumors, as mentioned above under **Assets in Intrigue: Trade and Secrets**. Tangible assets are often in the form of evidence or coveted valuables.
- ✧ The **skill** you roll in an intrigue contest is normally a **Communicate** skill test for you, to get close enough to strike; your opponent may use **Discipline** or **Communicate** in response.

- ✧ If you fail your contest, it may lead to the target seeking to avenge such a slight, which could include a challenge to single combat if they are of a militant inclination.
- ✧ If your successful attack leads to an extended task (meaning the foe is not a minor character), the task's requirement usually equals the foe's **Discipline** skill.
- ✧ A **lasting defeat** involves the loss of social standing, a lasting impact upon the character's reputation, a disgrace or dishonor that will be talked about at social events for a considerable time, and perhaps even having influence and power taken from them by their betters.

Example: Kara's next move is to see if the rumor can grant her any leverage with the partner or secretary. In further roleplaying scenes, Kara engages with each of them. The secretary isn't bothered about the rumor, so it cannot be used to initiate a conflict. But that does tell Kara the secretary has no part in it. However, the gamemaster rules the partner can be brought into a conflict by using the asset. This at least tells Kara the partner is involved, or at least worried about the consequences of an affair being revealed.

Kara initiates a conflict with the partner (in a roleplaying scene) and successfully defeats the partner in the contest. The partner breaks down and explains she is the one the spice merchant is having an affair with. The gamemaster grants Kara the partner as a new asset, representing her confession.

Now Kara can bring all these assets to a conflict with the spice merchant. Kara won't need an asset to initiate a conflict, as she can negotiate with the merchant at any time. But the assets help her reduce the Difficulty due to the spice merchant's disposition in those negotiations. Kara and the merchant enter a contested test, with Kara managing to defeat the merchant, winning a much better spice deal for her House as long as she keeps a few secrets.

DEFEAT

A character defeated in intrigue simply departs the scene; they may leave voluntarily, or be forcibly ejected, but either way, they are no longer present to participate in the scene. They may also suffer reputation loss if the defeat is public. Defeat may also cause the target to submit utterly to the will of the victor for a time, having been forced to capitulate to their argument or leverage. It may grant the victor a new asset, such as an owed favor, new resources, or even their rival themselves forced to act as their agent.

TARGETING ASSETS

It can be useful to try and undermine the assets of your opponent during an intrigue scene. This involves challenging the truth of information, casting doubt upon the provenance or worth of resources and other valuables, and similar means of rendering an asset ineffective.

- ❖ Knowledge assets can be tricky to target, unless your character has access to information which appears to contradict that knowledge, or some way to cast doubt upon the validity or worth of that knowledge. Once doubt has been established, the leverage of knowledge is greatly diminished, but it can be recovered if the information can be properly verified by a trusted source.
- ❖ Lies and rumors are similar to knowledge, but easier to produce and easier to remove, as they have little or no basis in truth to begin with. Once sufficient doubt has been cast upon a lie or rumor asset, it loses any Quality it had.
- ❖ Valuables can be difficult to target, as the asset represents items with actual physical presence and real worth. As with knowledge, casting doubt upon the real worth of a valuable is possible—are these art items real or fake, do you have as much of this mineral as you claim, etc.—but often more effective is demonstrating that there is no need or demand for those valuables. A shipment of rare raw materials is less useful as leverage against a person who has no need for those materials, or who can obtain those materials more cheaply elsewhere.

CREATING A TRAIT OR ASSET

Creating traits can help shape the landscape in intrigue, creating options, opportunities, and connections that may not have existed before.

- ❖ A created trait may lay the groundwork for other actions later, such as establishing a good rapport with a character you may wish to deal with later, or a falsehood that you've managed to convince someone else to believe.
- ❖ Tangible assets are difficult to create in intrigue, but it is entirely possible to pass them between characters; obtaining an asset from another party within the scene to use for your own purposes can be quite useful, but you may have to give something up to achieve that.
- ❖ Intangible assets are most commonly lies and rumors, including lies about what valuables or knowledge your character possesses. These are easy to create, but easy to destroy as well, and it is potentially dangerous to lean too heavily on deceit to achieve your goals in intrigue, as it can result in many resentful people who regard your character as a cheat and a liar.

OVERCOMING AN OBSTACLE

Obstacles in intrigue are not typically physical obstructions so much as social or political ones. Secretive or isolated factions may be difficult or impossible to reach under normal circumstances, even if connections exist.

Overcoming such obstacles typically requires work establishing legitimate—or seemingly-legitimate—reasons for access, such as proving yourself worthy or useful to an isolated group who shun outsiders, or obtaining letters of introduction or some other reason to reach a reclusive but powerful individual.

These typically require **Communicate** or **Understand** tests, but tests of worth may require **Battle**, **Move**, or **Discipline** tests depending on the nature of the group you're seeking to access.

GAINING INFORMATION

Information is valuable in intrigue, so naturally this action is undertaken frequently during intrigue scenes.

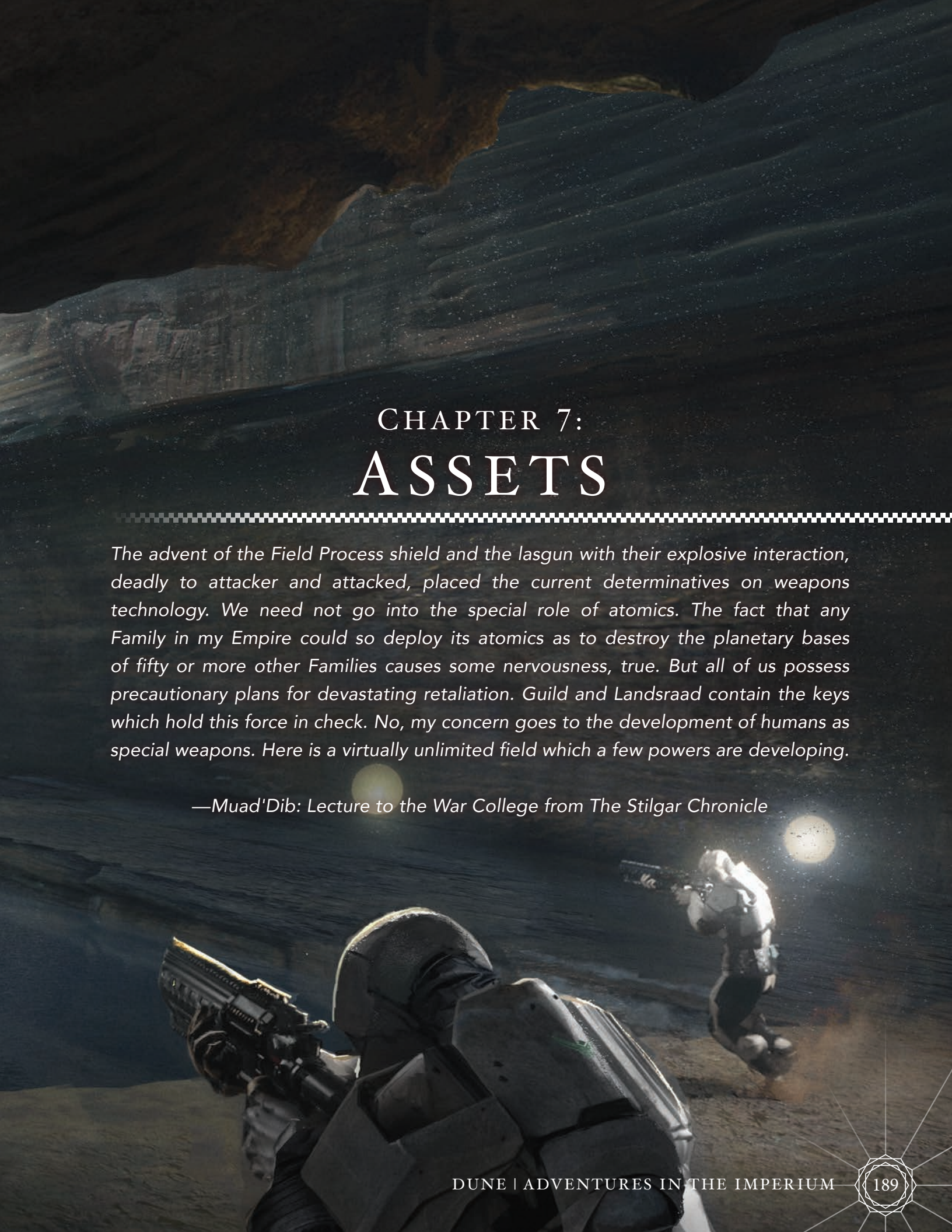
Most characters in an intrigue scene are fairly guarded about their goals and their feelings, seeking to maintain a mask of neutrality where their true intent cannot be easily guessed. As noted above, characters in an intrigue scene have dispositions—how they feel about other characters—and desires—what they wish to gain—which guide their actions, but most try to keep those secret.

So, gaining information about who wants what, and who likes or dislikes whom, can be an invaluable part of an intrigue, as you cannot easily get what you want unless you can navigate these social battlefields. This normally involves observation and asking around, trying to glean information from other people. Some may give up small amounts of information freely, while others may be more forthcoming but only if they get something in return, and some information can be obtained simply by standing back and observing proceedings. This is, in fact, an ability that many Bene Gesserit master, allowing them to discern subtle details from signs that most wouldn't even notice.

Learning the disposition of another character is relatively straightforward, requiring only Momentum to be spent to Obtain Information (one question lets you ask the disposition of one character toward a single other character). Learning desires is a longer process.

Discovering the desire of a character is an **extended task**, with a requirement equal to that character's Discipline. Overcoming that extended task reveals the target character's desire. Each successful attempt to gather information scores points toward that requirement equal to your character's **Understand** minus two. You may spend 2 points of Momentum to add +1 to the number of points scored.





CHAPTER 7: ASSETS

The advent of the Field Process shield and the lasgun with their explosive interaction, deadly to attacker and attacked, placed the current determinatives on weapons technology. We need not go into the special role of atomics. The fact that any Family in my Empire could so deploy its atomics as to destroy the planetary bases of fifty or more other Families causes some nervousness, true. But all of us possess precautionary plans for devastating retaliation. Guild and Landsraad contain the keys which hold this force in check. No, my concern goes to the development of humans as special weapons. Here is a virtually unlimited field which a few powers are developing.

—Muad'Dib: Lecture to the War College from The Stilgar Chronicle

TOOLS AND RESOURCES



As mentioned in **Chapter 6: Conflict**, characters employ assets to manipulate and overcome opponents and obstacles during difficult situations. These assets come in a wide variety of forms and types, ranging from personal items like knives, shield belts, portable poison snoopers, or symbols of office; vehicles such as ornithopters and groundcars; to the service of groups of servants or soldiers, or agents like spies and informants; or resources such as valuable goods or raw materials. Assets may also take the form of information known about an enemy, rumors spread to discredit them, or similarly intangible advantages.

Assets are merely tools for the characters' goals; what matters is how they are used. This is not merely a matter of the skill with which those tools and resources are employed, but also the ends to which they are employed.

STRUCTURE OF AN ASSET

All assets share a common structure that lets you see what they're useful for and how effective they are at a glance. These elements are described below.

Functionally, an asset works as a trait (see p.143-144 & p.164) with the asset's **name**. The other details of an asset are there to provide extra context and differentiation between assets. Each describes a tool, resource, or something else useful which a character possesses.

These assets are used during a conflict (as described in **Chapter 6: Conflict**) to overcome opponents and obstacles just like traits, usually in the following ways:

- ✧ To make a task possible when it otherwise would not be (such as using lockpicks to pick a lock).
- ✧ To make a task easier, reducing the difficulty (such as using a weapon to attack an opponent rather than bare hands).
- ✧ To make a task harder for an opponent (such as using a blade or shield to parry an attack).

Some assets are **tangible**—representing physical things, from weapons and other small possessions, to vehicles such as groundcars and ornithopters, to squads of troops and the services of agents and other subordinates. Others are **intangible**, representing contacts, favors, the ability to call upon friends, and similar useful things which have no physical presence in their own right.

Additionally, some assets are hard to come by and must be either purchased or provided specially by the character's patrons or House. These are usually expensive or use advanced technology such as shields and ornithopters. If a character is trying to create such as asset during

play the gamemaster may not allow it without a good reason why they would have access to such a thing. Other assets can be considered **ubiquitous** and are freely available almost everywhere, and easily brought into a scene with a Momentum/Threat spend.

When characters choose their starting assets, or gain assets with advancement, and they opt for a ubiquitous asset as one of their starting assets it should also have another aspect that will grant it a broader range of useful applications, such as the following:

- ✧ The asset can be easily concealed.
- ✧ A sign of sigil on the asset proves the owner has the backing of someone powerful.
- ✧ The asset has a secret compartment.
- ✧ The asset can be used as another asset (such as the way a crysknife represents more than just a weapon to the Fremen).

NAME

An asset's name will normally serve as a basic description of what the asset is. This name will normally provide some clues as to the circumstances where the asset will be useful—a dagger is obviously be of some use in single combat, for example—but this may not be the whole story.

KEYWORDS

Keywords provide an additional context for how an asset may function and the situations where it may be useful. An asset may have 2–3 keywords, most of which may only be a single word. The keywords don't do anything themselves—there are no specific rules which refer to them—but they can be useful prompts when determining if or how an asset applies to a situation. Knowing that a particular asset is a *ranged weapon* tells you the circumstances where it is useful (and the ones where it isn't, such as if an enemy is shielded).

CREATING AND DEVELOPING ASSETS

In addition to knowing how assets work, it is necessary to know who has which assets.

- ✧ Main player characters begin play with three assets, as described on p.122.
- ✧ Notable supporting characters have a single asset each, created the first time they appear.
- ✧ Minor supporting characters have no assets, except at the gamemaster's discretion, such as when assets would be necessary for the character to perform their duties.

- ❖ Non-player characters have whichever assets the gamemaster wants or needs them to have, with some consideration as to the kinds of resources a given non-player character has access to.

Beyond these initial assets, characters can obtain assets in several ways during play.

ASSETS AND TRAITS

All characters can attempt to create assets in play, in the same way that they can attempt to create Keywords: at their core, assets are essentially just a slightly more detailed form of trait.

As noted in **Chapter 5: Core Rules**, a character can create a trait by spending 2 points of Momentum (normally after a successful test, but the gamemaster may waive this requirement), or by succeeding at a skill test with a Difficulty set by the gamemaster (normally 2). These common methods can be used to obtain assets as well, though the context of the skill test will determine what kinds of assets you're able to create.

Intangible assets can be created in most situations, as they have no physical form and thus tend to represent the benefits of position, information gained, contacts, favors, and similar benefits. What kind of intangible assets are created depends on the circumstances and the actions taken: creating an asset based on positioning requires moving to an advantageous position, while creating an asset based on a favor from someone else requires convincing that person to perform a favor for your character.

The drawback to this is that intangible assets are often easier to lose: they can be taken from your character or rendered useless with relative ease, because they are intangible. Knowledge can be invalidated, positions can be lost, contacts may turn away from you, those who owe favors may refuse to give aid, and so forth. This won't happen unless the gamemaster has a non-player character take action against your character or through the spending of Threat (and even then, there must be a reason for your character to lose an asset), but it is a risk worth considering.

Tangible assets are a little trickier to create because they have physical presence—they are substantive, physical things which exist, such as spice. You can reasonably only create a tangible asset during a scene if...

- ❖ Your character could normally obtain that asset. Perhaps your character gained the asset in trade, or by leveraging your House's wealth, status, and resources. Maybe your character simply found it in the environment where the scene is taking place.
- ❖ Your character could reasonably have already obtained the asset and simply be revealing it now. The asset must be something your character could

conceal on their person or within the environment (if they've been there before or had time to prepare), such as a concealed blade, or a squad of troops using camouflage or disguise. Your character is assumed to have obtained the asset at some undisclosed earlier time, without anyone else knowing.

However you choose to create an asset, the asset is created with keywords chosen by the gamemaster (you may suggest keywords, but the gamemaster's ruling is final here; you get to choose the kinds of assets you create, but the gamemaster gets to define the specifics), and it has a Quality of 0. You may, when creating an asset, spend 2 points of Momentum to increase the asset's Quality to 1, to represent obtaining a better-than-average asset.

DETERMINATION AND ASSETS

One method of creating a trait is by spending **Determination**. This is just as useful for creating assets, though these factors are worth considering:

- ❖ Assets created with Determination have a basic Quality of 1, or 2 if you spend 2 points of Momentum to increase the asset's Quality.
- ❖ Tangible assets are considered to have been obtained previously and are only being revealed now; you must give a brief description of how you obtained the item.
- ❖ Assets created with Determination remain in play for the remainder of the current session.

This means that assets created using Determination are often more significant and effective than most newly-created assets and require a little more thought be put into their creation. Because you must describe how your character obtained the item, this is an ideal opportunity to reveal or elaborate upon some aspect of your character, particularly if it relates to the drive statement you used when you spent the Determination.

